



Carl Sadler sifts through the contents of some of the 94 boxes of groceries the Almonte Lions Club distributed Dec. 21 to needy families all around the area.

Warden accentuates positive in look back on 1993 term

By Pat Uguccioni
Gazette reporter

In reflection, the former captain of the county ship prefers to remember the calmer waters.

As warden, North Elmsley Reeve Laurie Duncan steered the county through a tumultuous year that included social contract cuts and the suspension of the eight-year-old waste management master plan.

In an interview Monday he chose to accentuate the positives instead of dwelling on the negatives. The list of thank yous ran longer than an academy award winner's acceptance speech. His family and county colleagues and support staff received the lion's share of accolades.

As for his official duties, Duncan said two highlights included the opening of the new wing of the Lanark Lodge and Lieutenant Governor Henry Jackman's official visit to the county.

When Duncan took the reins from Pakenham reeve Harry Farr more than a year ago, he made just one promise — to hold tax increases under two per cent. It was considered a bold statement, considering the best his predecessor could muster was an unprecedented 22 per cent tax hike.

At the time Duncan admitted his projection "may be impossible," but it would be the message sent to department heads.

Someone was obviously listening to Duncan's plea that "the public is being taxed to the limit and we must remember



Duncan

that" as the county came in under the two per cent ceiling.

Duncan couldn't name them all, any maybe that emphasizes the magnitude of the accomplishment, but the North Elmsley reeve was ecstatic the county road system received the attention he

said it deserved at the start of his one-year term.

He said an "excellent" council was instrumental in allowing him to accomplish personal goals he set out at the start.

"You can't do it all yourself," he emphasized. "They all helped me remarkably."

Duncan did leave his post with one disappointment. When he first occupied the warden's chair he hoped a home could be found for a county landfill before he stepped down in 12 months.

Of course that wasn't the case and in fact the process is in greater turmoil now that a provincial funding cap forced the suspension of the planning study.

A year ago he placed the blame for past delays squarely on the province, saying "the Ministry of Environment has failed to tell us what the rules are."

The ministry has been another source of frustration for the county in the past year, culminating in the August announcement it was capping funding for the project "for the foreseeable future."

Ever the optimist, Duncan looks to the new year with renewed hope, saying recent closed door talks with ministry officials has him thinking the process will be back on track soon.

"Sure it was a disappointment," he said of the latest delay. "But things are looking up."

What's his advice for the incoming warden, Margaret Duncan?

"Just listen and keep your ear to the ground."

Calendar

Wednesday to Friday, Jan. 5-7

Give your feet a treat at the foot care clinic at the Almonte/Ramsay and District Home Support Program office at 154 Bridge St. Call 256-4700 for appointments anytime after 9:15 a.m.

Saturday, January 8

The Big Brothers / Big Sisters' 11th annual ice fishing derby takes place on Clayton Lake (off the Clayton Lake Road) from 9 a.m. to 5 p.m. For more information call Rod Merrithew at 256-1541.



A benefit for accident victim Jack Folkard rocks the upstairs hall at the arena starting at 8 p.m. See Sinister Sam and Boys Nite Out for only \$5. For tickets or more information call 256-0469.

Sunday, January 9

The Mississippi Valley Field Naturalists are holding a family sleigh ride at 1 p.m. at Fulton's Pancake House and Sugar Bush in Cedar Hill. What a lovely way to spend a Sunday afternoon during the Christmas break. All members are welcome. Hot chocolate will be served.



Tuesday, January 11

Pakenham Township's Home Support Program invites area residents to the next of many "Tuesday hot lunches" — our E.A.T. program — from 10 a.m. to 2 p.m. at St. Andrew's United Church hall. Lunch is served at noon so there's plenty of time to socialize. For a ride or more information call Betty or David at 624-5619.

Come to lunch with the Almonte General Hospital Auxiliary at noon in the hospital board room. A general meeting will follow. For more information call Joan Sealey at 256-3689.

Civilians line dancing classes will resume at 7:30 p.m. at the arena hall. Everyone is welcome. For more information call 256-4077.

Wednesday, January 12

Seniors are invited to the Legion hall from 2 to 4 p.m. as it becomes a "drop in centre." For transportation call 256-4179.

Appleton W.I. members enjoy night out Dec. 9

The Appleton Women's Institute met at Kitchenette Restaurant in Carleton Place on Dec. 9 at 6 p.m. for their Christmas dinner and meeting. Sixteen members were present.

Elaine Munro is again our H leader for a baking club. The fees for this year will be \$15 reported by secretary Marion Timmons.

Vera Thompson was asked to find out if the group could have Baptist Sunday School Hall for

our winter meetings. This has been discussed and they would like to have a donation for heat.

On Wednesday, Dec. 15 boxes for shut-ins are to be packed at Lois Munro's home. Pennies for friendship were taken.

Mary Brydges won the prize donated by a member.

The next meeting is Jan. 18 at 7:30 p.m. in the Baptist Sunday School room on Reserve Street, Almonte.

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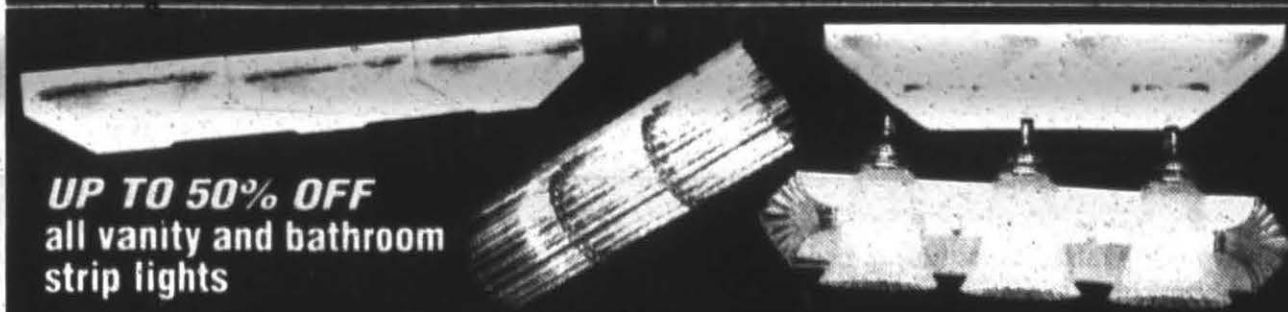
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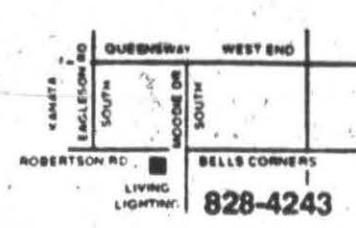
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